

Admin Dashboard

Data Entry Guide

A step-by-step handbook for adding and managing categories, products, images, and customer queries.

Prepared for	Data entry team
System	Rakesh Packers Admin Dashboard
Access URL	/dashboard/ on the website
Support	Contact your website administrator

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Who this guide is for

You do not need any programming or database knowledge. If you can use a form on a website, you can use this dashboard. Just follow the numbered steps in each section.

1. Getting started — signing in

The admin dashboard is a private area of the Rakesh Packers website. You must sign in with the username and password provided to you by the administrator before you can add or change anything.

Step-by-step

- 1 Open a modern web browser (Chrome, Edge, or Firefox).
- 2 Type the website address in the address bar and add **/dashboard/** at the end. For example: `https://rakeshpackers.com/dashboard/`
- 3 You will see the **Admin sign in** screen.
- 4 Type your **username** in the first box.
- 5 Type your **password** in the second box.
- 6 Click the **Sign in** button.
- 7 If the details are correct, you will land on the Dashboard home page.

Keep your login private

Do not share your username and password. Do not save them on shared computers. If you think someone else knows your password, ask the administrator to change it.

If sign-in fails

- You will see a red message that says **Invalid username or password**.
- Check that you did not accidentally add extra spaces before or after your username.
- Check that **Caps Lock** is not on.
- If it still does not work, contact the administrator — do not keep trying.

Signing out

Always sign out when you finish working, especially on a shared computer. The **Logout** button is at the bottom of the left sidebar on every dashboard page.

2. Dashboard overview

After signing in you will see the main dashboard. There are two areas: the **left sidebar** for navigating between sections, and the **main area** that shows the content of the current section.

The left sidebar

- **Dashboard** — the home page. Shows how many products, categories, images and customer queries are in the system.
- **Categories** — the list of product categories (like *Sweet Boxes* or *Pizza Boxes*). Add, edit, or delete categories here.
- **Products** — the list of all products. Add, edit, or delete products here. This is also where you add product images.
- **Queries** — messages that customers sent through the website contact form. You can read them and delete them.
- **Logout** — sign out of the dashboard.
- **View site** — opens the customer-facing website in a new tab, so you can check how your changes look.

The main dashboard tiles

The four coloured tiles at the top of the Dashboard show live totals (products, categories, product images, and customer queries). Click a tile to jump straight to that section.

Messages after every action

Whenever you save, delete or upload something, a coloured message appears near the top of the screen for a few seconds:

- **Green** = the action succeeded.
- **Red** = something went wrong. Read the message before continuing.

3. Managing categories

A **category** is a group of similar products — for example, *Cake and Pastry Boxes*, *Sweet Boxes*, *Pizza Boxes*. Every product should belong to a category so that customers can browse the website easily.

Rule of thumb

Always create the category **first**, then create the products that belong to it. That way the category will appear in the dropdown when you add a new product.

3.1 Adding a new category

- 1 Click **Categories** in the left sidebar.
- 2 Click the black **+ Add category** button in the top-right.
- 3 In the **Name** box, type the category name — for example, *Sweet Boxes*. This is what customers will see.
- 4 In the **Description** box, you can type a short sentence about the category. This field is optional — leave it blank if you don't need it.
- 5 Click **Create category**. You will be taken back to the list, and a green message will confirm the category was created.

3.2 Editing a category

- 1 Click **Categories** in the left sidebar.
- 2 Find the category you want to change in the list.
- 3 Click the grey **Edit** link on the right side of that row.
- 4 Change the **Name** or the **Description**.
- 5 Click **Save changes**.

Warning about renaming

If you rename a category, the new name will show everywhere on the website immediately. Products already inside that category will automatically show the new category name.

3.3 Deleting a category

- 1 Click **Categories** in the left sidebar.
- 2 Find the category you want to delete.
- 3 Click the red **Delete** button on the right side of that row.
- 4 A pop-up will ask you to confirm — click **OK** to delete.

You cannot delete a category that still has products

The system will show a red error like *“Cannot delete — 3 product(s) still linked to this category.”* First edit each product and either move it to another category or delete it. Then come back and delete the category.

3.4 Category fields — quick reference

Field	What to enter	Required
Name	The short name customers will see, e.g. <i>Sweet Boxes</i> .	Yes
Description	Optional. A short sentence about the category. Not shown on every page, but useful for reference.	No

Best practices

Keep category names short and clear (2–4 words). Use plural form (*Sweet Boxes*, not *Sweet Box*). Do not create very similar categories like *Cake Boxes* and *Cakes Box* — pick one.

4. Managing products

A **product** is one item you sell. Each product has a name, a category, an optional price, and one or more images. Adding a product is a two-step process: first create the product, then add its images.

4.1 Adding a new product

- 1 Make sure the correct category already exists (see Section 3). If not, create it first.
- 2 Click **Products** in the left sidebar.
- 3 Click the black **+ Add product** button in the top-right.
- 4 Fill in the product fields (see the table on the next page for details).
- 5 Click **Create product** at the bottom-right of the form.
- 6 You will be taken to the same product's edit page. Now the **Product images** panel on the right is active — see Section 5 to add photos.

Why images are added after saving

Images are stored separately and linked to the product. The system needs to know which product to attach them to, so it asks you to save the product details first.

4.2 Editing an existing product

- 1 Click **Products** in the left sidebar.
- 2 Find the product you want to change in the list.
- 3 Click the grey **Edit** link on the right side of that row.
- 4 Change any field you want.
- 5 Click **Save changes** at the bottom.
- 6 You can also add or remove images on this same page — see Section 5.

4.3 Deleting a product

- 1 Click **Products** in the left sidebar.
- 2 Find the product to delete.
- 3 Click the red **Delete** button in that row.
- 4 Click **OK** in the confirmation pop-up.

Delete is permanent

Deleting a product also deletes all of its images from storage. There is no undo. If you are unsure, edit the product to remove it from a category instead.

4.4 Product fields — full reference

Field	What to enter	Required
Product name	The full name of the product, e.g. <i>Creative Burger Box</i> . This is what customers see first.	Yes
Category	Pick from the dropdown. If your category is missing, use the <i>Add one</i> link below the dropdown.	No
Price (₹)	The selling price in rupees. Numbers only, e.g. 149 or 99.50 . Leave blank if the price is on request.	No
Size	A short size description shown to the customer, e.g. <i>12 × 12 × 4 inches</i> or <i>500 ml</i> . Optional.	No
Slug	The short address used in the URL. If you leave this blank the system will generate it automatically from the product name. Only change it if you know what you are doing.	No
Short description	A one- or two-sentence summary shown on the product listing. Optional but recommended.	No
Detailed description	A longer description shown on the product's own page. Use the editor toolbar (bold, italic, lists, links). This is the field for everything a customer might want to know.	No
Catalogue links	Optional. Paste one PDF or brochure URL per line. Only use this if the product has downloadable material.	No

Writing good descriptions

The short description appears in lists and on the home page — keep it under 200 characters. Use the detailed description for materials, sizes, MOQ, printing options, and anything else customers ask about.

5. Uploading product images

Every product should have at least one image. Images are added on the same page where you edit the product, in the **Product images** panel on the right side of the screen.

Before you upload

Use clear, well-lit photos. Prefer square images (same width and height) at 1000 × 1000 pixels or larger. Accepted file types: **JPG, PNG, WEBP**. Keep each image below 5 MB where possible.

5.1 Uploading from your computer

This is the recommended way — the image is uploaded to secure storage and a permanent link is created automatically.

- 1 Open the product's edit page (see Section 4.2).
- 2 Look at the right side of the screen for the **Product images** panel.
- 3 You will see a dashed box that says **Click to choose files**.
- 4 **Option A — click:** click the dashed box, then pick one or more image files from your computer and click **Open**.
- 5 **Option B — drag and drop:** open your computer's file browser next to the web browser, then drag the image files into the dashed box.
- 6 You will see the message “*Uploading...*” for a few seconds.
- 7 When done, the message changes to “*Uploaded N image(s)*” and thumbnails of your new images appear below the box.

5.2 Using an existing image URL

If the image is already published somewhere on the internet (for example on your Google Drive share link or another website), you can add it by URL instead of uploading a file.

- 1 Open the product's edit page.
- 2 In the **Product images** panel, find the small input labelled *... or paste an image URL*.
- 3 Paste the full image address (must start with **http://** or **https://**).
- 4 Click **Add**.
- 5 A thumbnail will appear in the grid below.

Prefer uploads to URLs

URLs can break if the other website removes the image. Uploading the file itself is safer and faster for customers viewing your site.

5.3 Removing an image

- 1 Move your mouse over the image thumbnail in the image grid.

- 2 A small round black button with an × mark appears in the top-right corner of the thumbnail.
- 3 Click the × button.
- 4 Confirm the pop-up. The image is removed immediately, both from the product and from storage.

5.4 Common image mistakes to avoid

- Very dark or blurry photos — customers will scroll past.
- Screenshots of images (which lower quality) — always upload the original file.
- Uploading tiny images (under 400 × 400 px) — they will look pixellated when the site enlarges them.
- Uploading the same image twice — clean up duplicates.
- Forgetting to save the product after adding images. *Images are saved separately, but always click Save changes to keep any other edits you made in the form.*

5.5 Order of images

The first image you upload becomes the **main image** shown in product listings and in the shopping cart. If you want a different image to be the main one, remove all images and re-upload them in the order you want.

6. Customer queries

When a customer fills out the contact form on the website, their message is saved here so you can respond. You can only **view** and **delete** queries — you cannot reply from inside the dashboard (use email or WhatsApp for that).

6.1 Reading customer queries

- 1 Click **Queries** in the left sidebar.
- 2 You will see a table with every query the website has received, newest at the top.
- 3 Each row shows the customer's **name**, **email**, **phone**, their **message**, and the **date** received.
- 4 Click the customer's email to open your email client, or click the phone number to call.

6.2 Deleting a query

- 1 Find the query in the table.
- 2 Click the red **Delete** button in the right column.
- 3 Click **OK** in the confirmation pop-up.

Only delete after replying

Deleted queries cannot be recovered. Make sure you have already replied to the customer (by email, phone or WhatsApp) before you delete their message.

6.3 What you cannot do here

- You cannot **reply** from inside the dashboard. Use the customer's email address or phone number.
- You cannot **edit** a query message — it is a record of what the customer sent.
- You cannot **add** a new query manually — queries come only through the website contact form.

7. Quick reference & cheat sheet

Common tasks — one line each

Task	How
Add a category	Categories → + Add category → fill Name → Create
Add a product	Products → + Add product → fill form → Create → add images
Add product images	Open a product → drop files on the dashed box in the right panel
Change product price	Products → Edit → change Price (■) → Save changes
Move product to another category	Products → Edit → pick new category → Save changes
Delete an image	Open the product → hover the thumbnail → click ×
Delete a product	Products → Delete → confirm
Read a customer query	Queries → look in the table
Delete a query	Queries → Delete → confirm
See the customer-facing website	Sidebar → View site
Log out	Sidebar → Logout

Recommended daily workflow

- **Morning** — open *Queries* and check for new customer messages. Reply, then delete once handled.
- **When new products arrive** — create the category first (if new), then add each product and upload at least 2 photos.
- **When prices change** — edit the product and update the Price field. Save.
- **End of day** — click Logout.

8. Troubleshooting & tips

Sign-in problems

- **Invalid username or password** — check Caps Lock, extra spaces, and the correct letters. Ask the administrator to reset if needed.
- The login page will not open — check your internet connection and try refreshing the browser.

Category / product problems

- **“Cannot delete — N product(s) still linked to this category.”** Move or delete those products first.
- **New category not showing in the dropdown** — reload the product form page (press F5).
- **Changes not visible on the website** — press F5 on the public site to refresh; browsers sometimes cache old pages.

Image upload problems

- **“Upload failed”** — check your internet connection and try again. Very large files (over 10 MB) may need to be shrunk first.
- **Thumbnail is a broken image icon** — the URL you pasted is not a direct image link. Try uploading the file instead.
- **Images look pixellated on the site** — the source image is too small. Re-upload a larger version.

Golden rules

- Save often — click **Save changes** after every edit.
- Never share your password. Always log out at the end of the day.
- If a red error appears and you do not understand it, take a screenshot and send it to the administrator.
- Small edits are safer than big ones — change one field, save, and check the website before making the next change.

End of guide — thank you for keeping the website up to date.